

Sunday, 30 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 22° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Rain 21° 15°	MANCHESTER Rain 21° 15°	GLASGOW Showers 16° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The search is continuing for 33 British nationals who have been reported missing after devastating floods in Nepal.

Among those unaccounted for are a 13-year-old girl and a 14-year-old boy. The region has been hit by deadly floods, causing widespread concern.

DISASTER · UK
- 2

Four people have pleaded guilty to an arson attack on Jewish community ambulances in north-west London.

Vehicles belonging to a charity in Golders Green were deliberately set alight in March, leading to explosions. The incident caused significant damage and distress.

CRIME · UK
- 3

A man has died and at least six others were injured after a large sign fell at a Christian festival in West Sussex.

The tragic incident happened at the Big Church Festival near Steyning. Police are investigating the circumstances surrounding the 41-year-old man's death.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 4

A serial rapist police officer was allowed to pass vetting despite previous warnings about his behaviour, it has been revealed.

Alan Greer had been investigated for inappropriate phone calls to women in 2002 and 2005, with one case resulting in a formal police caution. This raises serious questions about police screening processes.

POLICE · UK
- 5

Andy Burnham has stated he will not vote on assisted dying, unlike Labour leader Keir Starmer, as MPs prepare for a vote.

The Mayor of Greater Manchester has called for all views on the sensitive issue to be respected. Parliament will vote in two weeks on legalising assisted dying in England and Wales.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The much-anticipated sequel, *Practical Magic 2*, is having its UK premiere in London, reuniting its original stars.**

Sandra Bullock and Nicole Kidman are back for the follow-up to their beloved film. Fans are excited to see the witches return to the big screen.

| ON AIR – If you could cast any spell, what would it be and why?

FILM · COMING UP
- 2 Reading and Leeds Festival has unveiled a major overhaul, hoping to attract a new and wider audience.**

Organisers have made significant changes to the line-up and experience for next year. It's an attempt to keep the iconic festivals fresh and appealing.

| ON AIR – What changes would you make to a big music festival to improve it?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 3 Jacob Elordi has been reflecting on his role in Sir Ridley Scott's new post-apocalyptic epic, *The Dog Stars*.**

The film explores themes of hope in a pandemic-riddled world. Elordi admits the role made him question what he was 'missing' in his own life.

| ON AIR – What film has made you think deeply about your own life?

FILM · COMING UP
- 4 Matt Lucas and Hugh Bonneville are among actors calling for a new law to protect against AI voice cloning.**

They want the government to give every person in the UK a legal right to own their voice. It's a growing concern for performers in the age of artificial intelligence.

| ON AIR – How much should we worry about AI cloning voices and images?

TECHNOLOGY · NOW
- 5 Paul Heaton has scored his first number one album, while Dolly Parton's classic '9 to 5' finally made the UK Top 40.**

Heaton's solo album has topped the charts, a fantastic achievement. Meanwhile, Parton's 1980 US hit has, at long last, reached the UK Top 40.

| ON AIR – What's an old song you love that you're surprised never made it big in the UK?

MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City cruised to a 4-1 victory over Crystal Palace, with Erling Haaland and Rayan Cherki both scoring twice.**

The impressive win saw City dominate the Premier League fixture. Cherki's two goals and swaggering display have many wondering if this is his moment to shine.

ON AIR – Is this the season Manchester City finally dominate the Champions League?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England are in a dominant position at Lord's, closing in on a series win against Pakistan in the second Test.**

They enjoyed a commanding day with both bat and ball, ending day two with a lead of 261. Ollie Robinson was particularly brilliant, taking four wickets for just 11 runs.

ON AIR – How confident are you about England's chances of winning the Ashes next year?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Leeds Rhinos have returned to the top of the Super League standings with a thumping away win at St Helens.**

Their comprehensive victory puts them ahead on points difference. It was a rare and impressive performance against a strong St Helens side.

ON AIR – Which Super League team do you think has the best chance of winning the Grand Final this year?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

4 **Newly-married Katie Boulter says she won't be making Andy Murray's wedding ring mistake as she prepares for the US Open.**

Murray famously lost his ring after tying it to his shoelaces during a practice session. Boulter, a rising star in British tennis, is clearly taking precautions!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual place you've ever stored something valuable?

TENNIS · UK

5 **Chaos erupted at a boxing weigh-in as British heavyweight Moses Itauma pushed Filip Hrgovic off the stage.**

The Croat retaliated by slapping Itauma, just before their world-title bout. It's certainly set the stage for a fiery fight!

ON AIR – Do you think pre-fight antics like this are good for boxing, or do they go too far?

BOXING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that the simple act of 'doodling' during meetings can actually improve your memory and concentration.**
It seems those little sketches aren't a sign of distraction after all, but rather a clever way your brain stays engaged and processes information more effectively.
- 2 The delightful trend of 'tiny libraries' is popping up in unexpected places, from phone boxes to garden sheds.**
These charming community book-swapping points offer a lovely way to discover new reads and share old favourites with neighbours.
- 3 Scientists have found that regularly looking at 'green spaces', even through a window, can significantly reduce feelings of stress.**
Just a glimpse of trees or a garden can provide a mental refresh, proving nature's calming power is always at hand.
- 4 There's a growing appreciation for the 'art of letter writing' as a mindful and personal way to connect with others.**
Taking the time to craft a handwritten note offers a deeper sense of connection than a quick email, making it a treasured keepsake for both sender and receiver.
- 5 New research highlights the benefits of 'short bursts of movement' throughout the day, even just a few minutes every hour.**
These micro-breaks can boost energy levels, improve focus, and contribute to overall well-being, especially for those with desk-bound jobs.
- 6 The surprising joy of 'rediscovering old hobbies' is bringing a wave of nostalgia and satisfaction to many.**
Whether it's knitting, painting, or model making, revisiting past passions offers a comforting escape and a chance to reignite forgotten skills.
- 7 Experts are suggesting that embracing 'seasonal eating' can lead to a more varied and flavourful diet.**
Enjoying fruits and vegetables when they're naturally in season often means they're at their freshest, tastiest, and most nutritious.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new TV programme will be good, without actually watching more than a minute?

ANSWER: CHANNEL HOPPING BACKWARDS AND FORWARDS TO SEE IF THE MAIN CHARACTERS CHANGE OUTFITS A LOT.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of freshly brewed coffee, especially if it's a new brand.

ANSWER: GIVING THE COFFEE JAR OR PACKET A GOOD SNIFF, EVEN IF THE LID IS SEALED.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a certain 'song' can instantly transport you back to a specific memory or a moment from your past?**
We'd love to hear about the songs that are like a time machine for you and the special memories they unlock. Give us a call!
- **We all have those 'little everyday inventions' that we think are absolutely genius, even if they're just things we've cobbled together at home.**
What's your cleverest shortcut, your homemade hack, or that brilliant little solution you came up with for an everyday problem? Share your ingenuity with us!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Penguins have a unique ability to 'fly' for short distances during their mating rituals, despite their usual inability to take to the air.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named Methuselah, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- The highest mountain in the British Isles is Ben Nevis, located in Scotland, standing at 1,345 metres (4,413 feet) above sea level.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The sound of thunder can reach temperatures hotter than the surface of the sun, causing the air to expand rapidly.
- The small island country of Nauru in the Pacific Ocean is the only country in the world with no official capital city.
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlllantysiliogogogoch, a village in Wales.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- The 'Great Fire of London' in 1666 started in a baker's shop on Pudding Lane.

On this day

Day 242 of the year, 123 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Constantinople (Eastern Orthodoxy); Christian feast day: Blessed Alfredo Ildefonso Schuster; Christian feast day: Blessed Eustáquio van Lieshout; Christian feast day: Blessed Stephen Nehmé (Maronite Church / Catholic Church). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1954 — David Paymer, American actor and director
- 1968 — Diran Adebayo, English author and critic
- 1966 — Michael Michele, American actress
- 1950 — Dana Rosemary Scallon, Irish singer and activist
- 1971 — Lars Frederiksen, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1966 — Peter Cunnah, Northern Irish singer-songwriter and producer
- 1951 — Timothy Bottoms, American actor
- 1985 — Richard Duffy, Welsh footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1967 — Thurgood Marshall is confirmed as the first African American Justice of the Supreme Court of the United States.
- 1963 — The Moscow–Washington hotline between the leaders of the U.S. and the Soviet Union goes into operation.
- 2021 — The last remaining American troops leave Afghanistan, ending U.S. involvement in the war.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1936 — The RMS Queen Mary wins the Blue Riband by setting the fastest transatlantic crossing.
- 2021 — The last remaining American troops leave Afghanistan, ending U.S. involvement in the war.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2008 — A Conviasa Boeing 737 crashes into Illiniza Volcano in Ecuador, killing all three people on board.
- 1945 — The Japanese occupation of Hong Kong comes to an end.
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1974 — The Third World Population Conference ends in Bucharest, Romania. At the end of the ceremony, the UN-Romanian Demographic Centre is inaugurated.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 243 of the year, 122 days left in 2026. Today Baloch-Pakhtun Unity Day (Balochs and Pashtuns, International observance); Christian feast day: Aidan of Lindisfarne; Christian feast day: Amatus of Nusco; Christian feast day: Aristides of Athens. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1979 — Simon Neil, Scottish singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1967 — Gene Hoglan, American drummer
- 1960 — Chris Whitley, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2005)
- 1992 — Holly Earl, British actress
- 1940 — Larry Hankin, American actor, director, and producer
- 1971 — Kirstie Allsopp, British TV presenter
- 1980 — Joe Budden, American broadcaster and former rapper
- 1986 — Ryan Kelley, American actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1959 — A parcel bomb sent by Ngô Đình Nhu, younger brother and chief adviser of South Vietnamese President Ngô Đình Diệm, fails to kill King Norodom Sihanouk of Cambodia.
- 2016 — Brazil's President Dilma Rousseff is impeached and removed from office.
- 1986 — The Soviet passenger liner Admiral Nakhimov sinks in the Black Sea after colliding with the bulk carrier Pyotr Vasev, killing 423.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1988 — Delta Air Lines Flight 1141 crashes during takeoff from Dallas/Fort Worth International Airport, killing 14.
- 2005 — The 2005 Al-Aimmah bridge stampede in Baghdad kills 953 people.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar